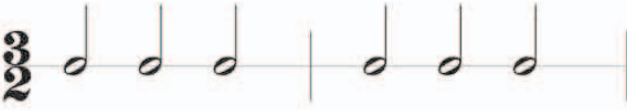


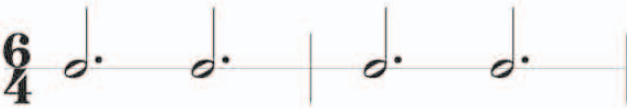
Other compound time signatures

Other dotted note values can also be used for the beat. In 3/2, there are three half note beats per measure (simple time), but 6/4 is a compound time signature—the beat is a dotted half note, and there are two beats in each measure. Compound time signatures normally have 6, 9, or 12 as the top number (multiples of three).



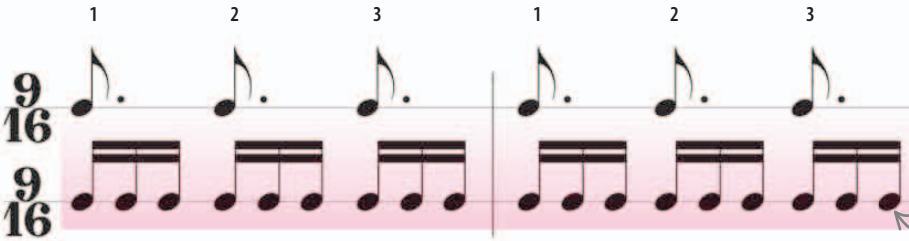
△ 3/2

In 3/2, there are three half notes per measure (simple time). Each half note subdivides into two quarter notes.



△ 6/4

In 6/4, the beat is a dotted half note and there are two beats in each measure. Each dotted half note subdivides into three quarter notes.



◁ 9/16

A 9/16 meter might be used for fast dancelike music, with three beats to the measure—each beat being a dotted eighth note.

In 9/16, each beat subdivides into three sixteenth notes.

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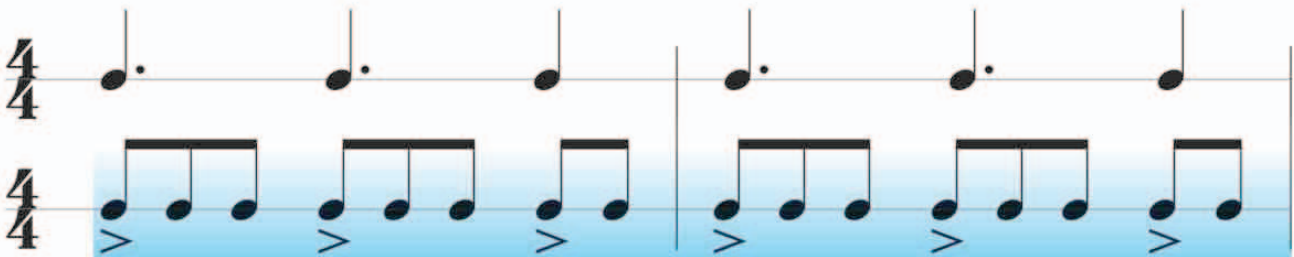
One in a measure

Some fast music, typically in 2/4, 3/4, or 3/8, is too fast for a conductor to beat all the quarter notes or eighth notes. In those instances, musicians talk about the music having a “one in a measure” feel—the conductor beats one beat per measure. The second movement of Beethoven's *Ninth Symphony*, marked “Molto vivace,” is a good example.



Irregular beat-groupings

Simple time signatures can be subdivided in irregular ways. A typical example has a 4/4 meter divided into a 3 + 3 + 2 pattern (where the numbers count as eighth notes), instead of the standard four quarter note beats. This sort of meter is widespread in African Caribbean and Latin American music.



▽ Calypso rhythm

- 11 The 3 + 3 + 2 pattern is particularly associated with calypso, but can be heard in folk and popular music from many parts of the world.